

Does this mean that everything is possible?

Leibniz thought that there must be **some** explanation of why there is a world at all because he endorsed a certain principle about explanation, known as the **principle of sufficient reason**.

possible

necessary

contingent

Not quite. Here are some things which do not seem to be possible, even
in this broad sense.

There is a three-sided plane
closed Euclidean figure with
four angles.

Alfred is taller than
Sam and Sam is taller
than Alfred.

There is an object which is bright red
and bright green all over.



Leibniz's
argument



the
PSR

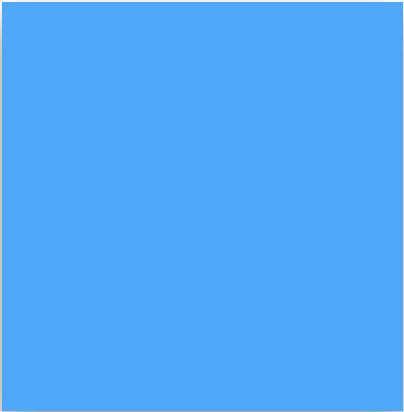


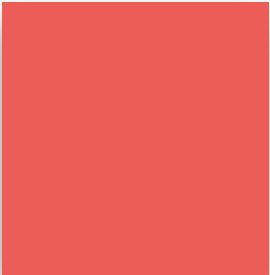
objections
to the
PSR

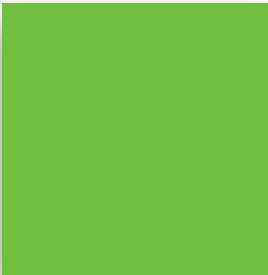
principle of sufficient reason.

all because he understood a certain principle about explanation, known as the

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closed. Evidence is being reviewed with

for air angles.

There is a three-sided plane



Affraidistaller than

Sam and Sam's trailer





and bright green all over.

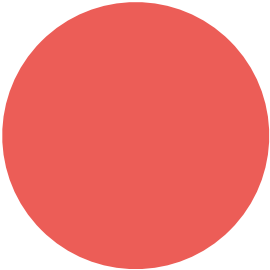
There is an object which is bright red

... we cannot find in any of the individual things, or even in the entire collection and series of things, a sufficient reason for why they exist.

Let us suppose that a book on the elements of geometry has always existed, one copy always made from another. It is obvious that although we can explain a present copy of the book from the previous book from which it was copied, this will never lead us to a complete explanation, no matter how many books back we go, since we can always wonder why there have been such books.

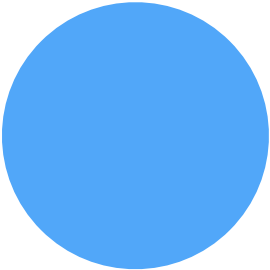
What is true of these books is also true of the different states of the world ... however far back we might go into previous states, we will never find in those states a complete explanation for why there is a world at all, and why it is the way it is.







objections
to the
PSR





cause exists, then God exists: the objection was that the first cause could

be Good.

simply be some event, like the Big Bang, which is not a plausible candidate to

Last time we considered an objection to Aquinas' assumption that if a first



Leibniz's
argument

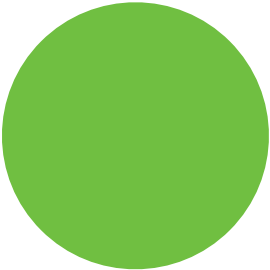


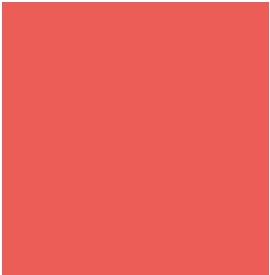
the
PSR





Leibniz's
argument





contingent

